

# **SY27/28 Enrollment Campaign Messaging**

# Overview

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**Objective:** Provide messaging framework for new SY27/28 enrollment marketing campaigns

- Executive Summary: Insights & Implications
- Network & Regional Value Proposition
- Brand Messaging Framework
- Messaging Direction

# Strategic Insights for New Campaign Messaging

Leveraging research & past results, new campaign messaging will promote our most ownable differentiators —our 30-year track record and elite, zero-cost offerings—to clearly define the Uncommon advantage to families.

|                          | Findings                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Implication                                                                                                                                                     |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Family Survey            | Families care most about safety & trust, high quality teachers & academics, and joyful classrooms that instill a love of learning                                                                                         | Demonstrate these qualities <b>through student and teacher stories</b>                                                                                          |
| In Market Ad Performance | Top-performing digital ads feature messaging focused on either compelling offerings & incentives (e.g., basketball, free college savings account), data-backed results (#1 school), or urgency (e.g., Seats Filling Fast) | Establish a <b>year-round creative testing framework</b> to continually measure, refine, and optimize ad performance                                            |
| Competitor Analysis      | Competitor messaging prioritizes academic results, joyful learning, and supportive community                                                                                                                              | Lean into the most distinct aspects of our value proposition—focusing on what is <b>uniquely ownable by Uncommon</b>                                            |
| Value Proposition        | Key differentiators include a 30-year track record of top-performing schools, high college acceptance rates, tailored student supports, and free, world-class co-curriculars & electives                                  | Develop an <b>overarching brand messaging framework</b> with content localization grounded in <b>each region's unique offerings</b> to maximize local resonance |

# Network-wide Value Proposition

| Pillars                     | All regions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Academics & Results         | <b>Graduate from college at four times the rate of their peers</b><br><br>Pass AP exams at a rate that is more than twice the national average                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Programs & Facilities       | HS Student Talent and Voice across all 9 high schools: <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Help students discover their purpose, talent and voice, enabling them to pursue their passions in college and beyond</li><li>• Career-focused extracurriculars like immersion days, internships, corporate mentorships</li></ul> |
| Student Supports & Services | <b>Programs open to all students, including SPED and MLL with tailored support</b><br><br>Free services ( e.g., Pre-K programs, uniforms, materials)<br><br><i>Automatic signup to 529 College Savings Accounts (NYC, NJ) (To be confirmed)</i>                                                                                 |
| Track record                | Backed by Uncommon Schools’ 30 years of impact                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

# Regional Value Proposition Variations

| PILLARS                                | BOSTON                                                                                                                                                                                                        | CAMDEN                                                                                                                           | NEWARK                                                                                                                             | NYC                                                                                                                                                          | ROCHESTER                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Academics & Results                    | 95% college acceptance<br><br>\$2.4M in college scholarships awarded to Roxbury Prep seniors                                                                                                                  | Highest performing school in Camden<br><br>96% college acceptance<br><br>Over \$1M awarded in college scholarships               | Top Performing School in NJ<br><br>94% college acceptance<br><br>Over \$13M awarded in college scholarships                        | Top performing schools in NYC (In Brooklyn,, 1 in 5 don't graduate)<br><br>98% college acceptance<br><br>\$8M awarded in college scholarships                | #1 Highest performing schools in Rochester<br><br>100% college acceptance<br><br>Over \$2.9M in college scholarships awarded                                  |
| Program, Facilities & Student Supports | New state of the art school building with modern science labs and athletic fields<br><br>Newcomer program offering support for immigrant families<br><br>Vocational partnerships with uMass, Harvard, Berklee | Free Pre-K program<br><br>New state-of-the art HS school<br><br>Internship opportunities with local corporate partners           | First public charter in the Ironbound<br><br>Scholar-Athlete program<br><br>Internship opportunities with local corporate partners | Free Pre-K program<br><br>Single sex education options<br><br>Wrap-around community and family support services<br><br>AP classes                            | Only charter school in Rochester serving grades K-12<br><br>Special education services<br><br>Internships and vocational programs with Rochester universities |
| Athletics & Extracurriculars           | Competitive sports including baseball, basketball, track, cheer<br><br>Co-curricular programs & clubs across arts, media, music, STEM                                                                         | Competitive sports and Camden's only varsity golf programs<br><br>Co-curricular programs & clubs across arts, media, music, STEM | After school clubs, & competitive athletics<br><br>Co-curricular programs & clubs across arts, media, music, STEM                  | Competitive clubs & extracurriculars including robotics, debate, drumline, chess, study abroad<br><br>Co-curricular programs across arts, media, music, STEM | Competitive sports & clubs<br><br>Co-curricular programs & clubs across arts, media, music, STEM                                                              |
| Track record                           | 28 years of proven results                                                                                                                                                                                    | Backed by 30 years of results                                                                                                    | 30 Years of Impact (logo)                                                                                                          | 30 Years of Impact (logo)                                                                                                                                    | 20 years of proven results                                                                                                                                    |

# Competitor Messaging

**Achievement First**  
Sponsored

A joyful place to learn and grow. Spaces are filling fast. Secure your child's spot for the 26-27 school year today!



Renaissance Academy Charter School of the Arts  
Inspired by Arts. Empowered by Learning.



**A free, high-performing charter public school in Boston**  
Preparing students in Pre-K through Grade 12 for success in college and beyond.

**Success Academy Charter Schools**  
Sponsored

Give your child an early start that will make a long lasting difference. Apply to early Kindergarten now.



APPLYTOSA.ORG  
Apply now for Kindergarten!

Apply Now

**Success Academy Charter Schools**  
Sponsored

STEM labs, art studios, basketball courts, soccer fields, and more —our new K-12 campus is a space where kids will thrive.



SABRONXK12.ORG  
Success Academy's new K-12 campus

Sign Up

**Zeta Charter Schools**  
Sponsored

Zeta outperformed 96% of all NYC public schools.



**KIPP Newark Public Schools**  
Sponsored

Families across Newark choose KIPP because students are known, supported, and celebrated. Our school community helps every child feel like they belong.



**Zeta Charter Schools**  
Sponsored

Top-performing charter school now accepting 9th grade applications.



**STRONG ACADEMICS. PERSONALIZED SUPPORT. REAL-WORLD OPPORTUNITIES.**

 **Mastery Schools**

# Competitive Overview

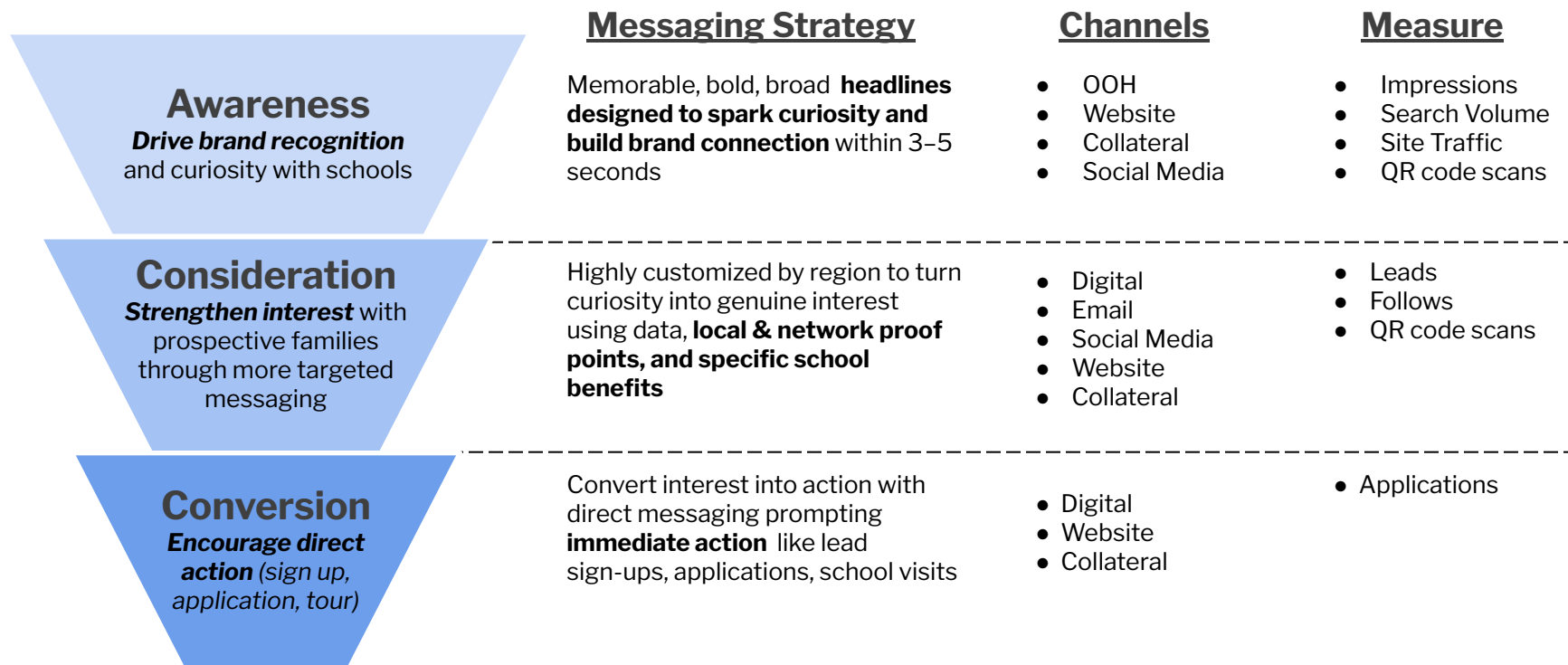
| BOSTON | CAMDEN  | NEWARK          | NYC               | ROCHESTER             |
|--------|---------|-----------------|-------------------|-----------------------|
| Brooke | KIPP    | KIPP            | Success Academy   | Roch. Academy Charter |
| Match  | Mastery | Great Oaks      | Achievement First | Genesee Community     |
|        |         | Mario P. Thomas | Ascend            |                       |



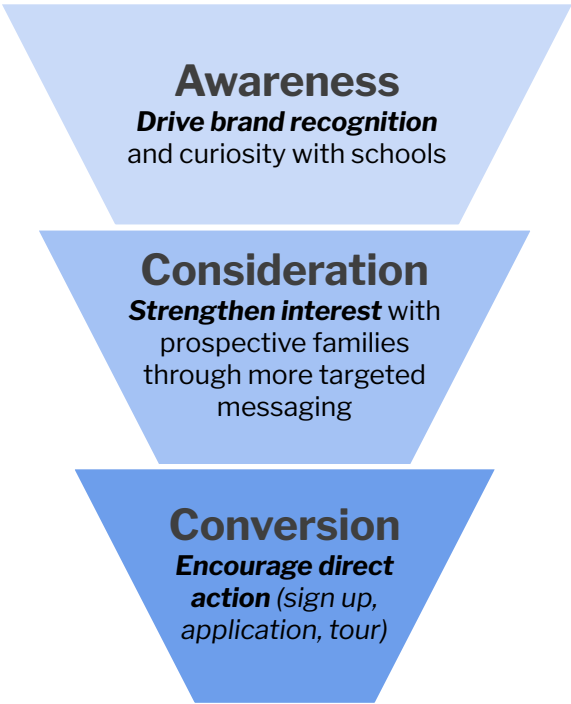
# Messaging Recommendation



# Messaging will target families at different stages of their journey through enrollment



# Message Mapping - Collateral



|                                  |                                |                                 |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Door Hanger                      | Large Retractable Event Banner |                                 |
| Enroll Banner                    | Referral Poster                |                                 |
| Enroll Poster                    | Table-size Retractable Banner  |                                 |
| -----                            |                                |                                 |
| Editable (Canva) School Brochure | Postcard (Non-Mailing)         |                                 |
| Editable Flyer (Canva)           | Pre-K Postcard                 |                                 |
| Postcard (Mailing)               | Referral Postcard              |                                 |
| -----                            |                                |                                 |
| General Brochure                 | MS Brochure                    | Sports 1-Pager                  |
| High School Brochure             | NYC Application                | Transportation 1-Pager          |
| Kindergarten Brochure            | Pre K Brochure                 | School Pathway Brochure         |
| Middle & High School 1-Pager     | Pre-K 1-Pager                  | Excellence Value Prop Resources |

# Setting the Stage for Differentiation

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**The Enemy:** *Zip code destiny.* It's the structural reality that a child's academic future and economic mobility are heavily predicted by their family's income and neighborhood.

**The Hero:** *Outstanding urban public schools.* The hero's power is sustained preparation. Uncommon doesn't promise a quick fix or just a passing test score; the hero prepares students for the endgame (college graduation).

## Strategic Lens:

- Functional: An education engineered for the rigor of college.
- Economic: Closing the opportunity gap. Securing the future.
- Emotional: Greatness is already in them. We provide the runway.

# Key Brand Message

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Greatness is already in them. **We provide** the runway.

Shows trust & love of the scholars and community support.

Unwavering belief in our model & leaders - backed by 30 years of impact.

Data backed results that prepare scholars for to and through college to close the opportunity gap.

# Brand Framework

Brand  
Promise

Greatness is already in them. We provide the runway.

Supporting  
Pillars

## Academics and Results

Graduate from college at four times the rate of their peers

Pass AP exams at a rate that is more than twice the national average

## Programs and Facilities

HS Student Talent and Voice

Help students discover their purpose, talent and voice

Career-focused extracurriculars

## Student Support and Services

Programs open to all students, including SPED and MLL with tailored support

Free services ( e.g., Pre-K programs, uniforms, materials)

## Track Record

Backed by Uncommon's 30 years of impact

Academic excellence scaled to 53 schools

# 30 Year Anniversary Local Usage [Enrollment **Recommendation**]

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[recommend regional logo lockups created  
for NS, NYC, RP]

## Local Campaign Uses:

- North Star, NYC, Roxbury Prep to use logo lock up with regional logo and 30 years of impact logo
- Camden: No 30th logo, accompanying copy, “Backed by 30 years of results”
- Rochester: No 30th logo, accompanying copy, “20 years of proven results”

# Enrollment Campaign: Key Phases & Milestones

| Planning                                 | Concepting                             | Media Planning                              | Production                                                                                                 | Launch                                     |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Initial Project Plan<br>May 22 - June 13 | Messaging Strategy<br>June 3 - June 13 | Agency Prep Media Plans<br>June 22 - July 6 | Collateral Production<br>June 17 - July 22<br>Media Prod. Design<br>June 22 - July 6                       | Campaign in Market<br>Oct 1                |
| Local Asset List Confirmed<br>June 10    | Content Mapping<br>June 17             | Media Plans Finalized<br>July 24            | Final Digital Collateral<br>Aug 4 - Sept 1 (wave 1)<br>Sept 15 - Oct 1 (wave 2)<br>Media Traffic<br>Aug 15 | Second Wave Collateral in Market<br>Oct 15 |



# Appendix





# Current Campaign Headlines *(used across OOH and digital)*

|                  | SY26/27 Campaign Headlines                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Recently Launched Headlines for Testing                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Boston</b>    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Top-Performing Schools. Tuition-Free.</li><li>• Find Your Voice. Discover Your Purpose.</li><li>• Last Chance to Apply</li></ul>                                                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• A school Boston families trust</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Camden</b>    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• #1 Highest Performing Schools in Camden</li><li>• Small Steps. Big Futures. Free Pre-K Opening Fall 2026.</li><li>• Find Your Voice. Discover Your Purpose</li><li>• Last Chance to Apply</li></ul>                                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• After school sports for Camden families</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Newark</b>    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Top-Performing K-12 Public Charter Schools in NJ</li><li>• Uncommon North Star Academy. Coming to the Ironbound</li><li>• Last Chance to Apply</li></ul>                                                                                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Explore sports, theater, robotics and more</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>New York</b>  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Top-Performing Pre-K - 12 Schools.</li><li>• Find Your Voice. Discover Your Purpose.</li><li>• Strength in learning. Pride in Brotherhood.</li><li>• Strength in learning. Pride in Sisterhood</li><li>• Last Chance to Apply</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Classrooms designed for girls to excel</li><li>• Classroom designed for boys to excel</li><li>• A Bed-stuy school that supports the entire family</li><li>• A Brownsville school that supports the entire family</li></ul> |
| <b>Rochester</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• #1 Highest Performing K-12 Schools in Rochester.</li><li>• Find Your Voice. Discover Your Purpose.</li><li>• Last Chance to Apply</li></ul>                                                                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Student Success Starts here</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                      |

# Past NYC Creative Test

**UNCOMMON SCHOOLS NEW YORK CITY**

**AT UNCOMMON, SAFETY ISN'T A GOAL, IT'S A GIVEN.**

At other Brooklyn schools, 1 in 3 students feel unsafe.

**UNCOMMON SCHOOLS NEW YORK CITY**

**YOUR CHILDREN DESERVE THE BEST EDUCATION.**

**OUR ELEMENTARY SCHOOLS OUTPERFORM 95% OF NYC PUBLIC SCHOOLS.**

**UNCOMMON SCHOOLS NEW YORK CITY**

**EVERY STUDENT DESERVES TO GRADUATE**

In Brooklyn, 1 in 5 don't. At Uncommon, all students earn their diploma.

**GIVE THEM A BRIGHT FUTURE**

**STUDENTS FROM UNCOMMON SCHOOLS GRADUATE FROM COLLEGE AT FOUR TIMES THE RATE OF THEIR PEERS.**

# Past Campaign Concepts

Uncommon Schools

CAMDEN PREP

## Learn Today, Lead Tomorrow

Make Us Your #1 Choice  
camdenenrollment.org (856) 605-5520

## Curious. Confident. College-Prepared.

### Apply Today!

northstaracademy.org/enroll  
(973) 474-5114

Uncommon Schools | NORTH STAR ACADEMY

## FIND YOUR VOICE. DISCOVER YOUR PURPOSE.

Free and Open to All

UNCOMMON SCHOOLS NEW YORK CITY

UNCOMMONSCHOOLS.ORG/ENROLLNYC

## Learn Today, Lead Tomorrow

Uncommon Schools

## Award-Winning, Free 5-12 Public Charter Schools in Boston

UNCOMMON SCHOOLS

ROXBURY PREP

## TOP-PERFORMING PRE-K – 12 SCHOOLS.

# Usage Guidelines

These rules ensure clarity, consistency, and proper brand hierarchy across all applications.

## Brand Hierarchy (Required)

- The Uncommon Schools logo must always remain the primary brand.
- The 30th Anniversary mark is secondary and must never visually overpower the Uncommon Schools logo.
- The anniversary mark is intended to support the brand, not replace it.

## Approved Lockups Only

- Use only the approved horizontal and vertical lockups shown in this document.
- Do not rearrange elements, alter hierarchy, or create new configurations.
- Do not mix elements from different lockups.

## Required Logo Pairing

- The 30th Anniversary mark may never be used on its own.
- It must always appear alongside the Uncommon Schools logo, using an approved lockup.
- Standalone use of “30,” “30 Years,” or “Years of Impact” without the Uncommon Schools logo is not permitted.

## Color and Treatment

- Use only the approved horizontal and vertical lockups shown in this document.
- Do not rearrange elements, alter hierarchy, or create new configurations.
- Do not mix elements from different lockups.

## Typography and Text Usage

- The anniversary logo is not typography.
- Do not use the logo inline within sentences, headlines, or body copy.
- Do not recreate the mark using text or attempt to typeset “30 Years of Impact” as copy.

## Prohibited Uses

- **Do not:** Use the anniversary mark in isolation.
- Alter colors, proportions, or layout.
- Remove the Uncommon Schools logo from any application.
- Break apart elements of the mark.
- Use the logo as decorative artwork or background pattern.
- Create new anniversary logo variations.

# 30th Campaign Overview

# WIP

## Internal Launch

Initial Project Plan

Budget

## Press Release

Messaging Strategy

## Schools Launch

Morning Circle, Events Toolkit, Gifts

## External Marketing Campaign

Enrollment and Staff Recruitment Media Campaign and Collateral

Enrollment and Staff Recruitment Media campaign and Collateral

## Donors

Development Salons, Impact Report

August

September

October

November

December